

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

*Ps Barry's
Reflections on:*
**PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION and
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions
No.39. 07th November 022



STAYING PLANTED

KEY WORDS:

“I” **MUST FALL**

“MY” **DYING**

PRODUCES NEW LIVES

John 12:23-25

23 Jesus replied that the time had come for him to return to his glory in heaven, and that “**I must FALL** and **DIE** like a kernel of wheat that **FALLS** into the furrows of the earth. Unless I die I will be alone-a single seed. But **MY DEATH** will **PRODUCE** many new wheat kernels-a plentiful harvest of new lives. 25 If you love your life down here-you will lose it. If you despise your life down here-you will exchange it for eternal glory. TLB



KEY WORDS:

- **PLANTED**
- **DYING**
- **PRODUCES NEW LIVES**

John 12:23-25

23 Jesus replied, “Now the time has come for the Son of Man to enter into his glory. 24 The truth is, a kernel of wheat must be **PLANTED in the soil**. Unless it **DIES** it will be alone a single seed. **But its DEATH will produce many new kernels--a plentiful harvest of new lives**. 25 Those who love their life in this world will lose it. Those who despise their life in this world will keep it for eternal life. NLT

JESUS REMAINED PLANTED

HE DIED, REMAINED IN THE EARTH **UNTIL** HE HAD ACCOMPLISHED THE PURPOSE FOR WHICH HE CAME INTO THIS WORLD.

KEY WORDS:

- **BURIED**
- **DEAD TO THE WORLD**
- **SPROUTS, REPRODUCES**

JESUS REMAINED BURIED

John 12:24-25

24 “Listen carefully: Unless a grain of wheat is **BURIED in the ground**, **DEAD to the world**, **it is never any more than a grain of wheat**. But if it is **BURIED**, it **sprouts** and **reproduces** itself many times over. 25 **In the same way**, anyone who holds on to life just as it is destroys that life. But if you let it go, **reckless in your love**, you’ll have it forever, real and eternal. **THE MESSAGE:**

STAYING PLANTED – REQUIRES **DYING** TO ONES OWN DESIRES & PLANS **and embracing God’s desires and plans**.

CHRIST WAS THAT SEED THAT FELL DOWN INTO THE GROUND AND DIED.

THIS WHOLE STORY IS ABOUT:

- **FALLING DOWN – PLANTED – BURIED**
- **DYING**
- **JESUS DEATH**
- **DELIBERATE CHOICE** – this was no accidental falling it was **DECISIVE ACTION** TAKEN.
- **LOVING OUR LIVES LESS**
- **LOVING ETERNAL THINGS MORE**
- **CONDITIONS THAT MUST BE MET - WERE** – being planted, buried, falling into **were mandatory**.

* IT'S ABOUT:

- How to **MULTIPLY** yourself
- How to **REPRODUCE** – create new lives.

* IT'S ABOUT:

- The willingness of someone (us) to **FALL DOWN**
- Someone's willingness to be **PLANTED**
- A willingness to **DIE** to our plans, aspirations, desires and to this world's ways.
- A willingness to **EXCHANGE** our plans for the **FATHERS** plans.

* IT IS ABOUT – JESUS who **deliberately chose** to:

- Come down - to stoop down
- To be a servant
- To REGAIN the Father's lost possession – fallen MAN

* **EXCEPT – UNLESS – "IF"**

- Unless there is **FIRST** a falling down, a planting, a dying then there is **NO** reproduction.
- **IF** this activity does not **FIRST** take place then there will be **no fruitfulness**, **no reproduction**, and the original seed **will remain** as a single seed.
- ONE is conditional on the **OTHER** taking place.
- **Fruitfulness and multiplication of the seed into many seeds** is dependent on staying planted – on remaining buried, for sufficient time so the one seed can germinated and bring forth many seeds.

* **THIS FALLING – COMING DOWN**

- This is not **ACCIDENTAL** falling – **NO**.
- It is the result of **DELIBERATE CHOICE**.
- The result of DEVOTION.
- The result of **SUBMISSION** to the will of a higher authority than their own.

* **IT WAS A WILLINGNESS TO IDENTIFY**

- To be **ONE WITH** something.
- To be **A PART** of something.
- With the view of being **ALONGSIDE** to help, assist, encourage.

* **IT WAS ALSO DIRECTIVE (down) TOWARDS** the place of need

- It involved **LOCATION** - the **earth** - (the **world**) **PEOPLE**
- IT WAS AWAY FROM** our rights and what we could claim as our legitimacy.

* **IT WAS HUMILITY IN ACTION - a willingness to LEAVE BEHIND - to COME DOWN FROM** that which could be **rightfully** be claimed.

- It was **NOT** for **OURSELVES** but for **PEOPLE** that **he came down** and died.

* **REMAINING PLANTED WHERE GOD HAS PLACED US**

Psalms 92:12-14

12 The [uncompromisingly] righteous shall flourish like the palm tree [be long-lived, stately, upright, useful, and fruitful]; they shall grow like a cedar in Lebanon [majestic, stable, durable, and incorruptible]. 13 Planted in the house of the Lord, they shall flourish in the courts of our God. 14 [Growing in grace] they shall still bring forth fruit in old age; they shall be full of sap [of spiritual vitality] and [rich in the] verdure [of trust, love, and contentment]. AMP

* **WOW - WHAT AN AMAZING PROMISE – THAT IT IS NOT AGE THAT DETERMINES FRUITFULNESS.**

IT IS ABOUT WHERE GOD HAS PLANTED (placed) US AND OUR WILLINGNESS OF STAY - REMAIN WHERE GOD PLANTED US.

Psalms 92:14

- *Even in old age they will still produce fruit and be vital and green. TLB*
- *They will still bear fruit in old age, they will stay fresh and green, NIV*
- *They bear fruit even when they are old; they are filled with vitality and have many leaves. NET*
- *They will still bear fruit in old age, healthy and green, Holman*
- *Even in old age they will still produce fruit; they will remain vital and green. NLT*

THAT'S THE SOURCE FOR SPIRITUAL YOUTHFULNESS – BEING FULL OF DIVINE SAP (LIFE SOURCE OF THE TREE FOR PRODUCING FRUIT) AND FOR KEEPING OUR LEAVES GREEN

* **LET US ALL REMAIN PLANTED IN WHAT HE HAS PLANTED AND DESTINED FOR US.**

Amen – Ps Barry

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